

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

events, where we want to live peacefully and confidently with our money. That's what I'm hoping to impart here – not a blow-by-blow account of how I did things, but a template for you to design a financial life that feels right for you.

I have made, and will probably continue to make, so many mistakes when it comes to money. The good news is that everybody else does too – they just won't always tell you about it. What's important to remember is that, in the same way that we only see one layer of anyone's life on social media, we are also very rarely privy to the inner workings of someone's bank account – even when we know them quite well. A good rule of thumb is to assume that even those you consider to be well-off, meticulously frugal or just really 'good with money' will have made at least one financial mistake. Mistakes are part of life, they are almost never completely irreparable and, even more importantly, they are an absolutely brilliant learning opportunity.

The missing piece in the self-care puzzle

As mentioned, I realized, once I pulled on the thread of what money meant to me, that personal finance has long occupied the wrong space on the bookshelves, the wrong section of the newspaper. It is lumped together with business and economics, the discussions too often led by a very specific type of person from a very specific type of background. With oodles of wealth privilege, and either no understanding – or an expired under-